that we object to, and once they have shed this, the way to co-operation will be open. What of the Moderates then? Probably they will accept the new order as another indication of the inscrutable wisdom of Providence.

One of the notable consequences of the Round Table Conference and the proposal to have a Federation, is to push the Indian Princes very much to the forefront. The solicitude of the Tory die-hards for them and their 'independence' has put new life into them. Never before have they had so much importance thrust on them. Previously they dared not say no to a hint from the British Resident, and the Government of India's attitude to the numerous highnesses was openly disdainful. There was continual interference in their internal affairs, and often this was justified. Even to-day a large number of the States are directly or indirectly being governed by British officers 'lent' to the States. But Mr. Churchill's and Lord Rothermere's campaign seems to have unnerved the Government of India a little, and it has grown cautious about interfering with their decisions. The Princes also now talk in a much more superior way.

I have tried to follow these superficial developments in the Indian political scene, but I cannot help feeling that they are unreal, and the background in India oppresses me. The background is one of continual repression of every kind of freedom, of enormous suffering and frustration, of distortion of goodwill, and encouragement of many evil tendencies. Large numbers lie in prison and spend their young lives, year after year, eating their hearts out.[1] Their families and friends and connections and thousands of others grow bitter, and a nauseating sense of humiliation and powerlessness before brute strength takes possession of them. Numerous organisations are outlawed even in normal times, and 'Emergency Powers' and 'Tranquillity Acts' make for themselves almost a permanent

[1] Sir Harry Haig, Home Member, stated in the Legislative Assembly on July 23, 1934, that the total number of detenus in gaols and special camps were: in Bengal, 1500 to 1600; in Deoli camp, 500. Total, 2000 to 2100. This is the figure for detenus; that is, untried and unconvicted prisoners. It does not include political convicts. In the case of convicts sentences are usually very heavy. In a recent Calcutta case the Associated Press (Dec. 17, 1934) states that the High Court gave a sentence of nine years' rigorous imprisonment, the offence being the unlicensed possession of arms and ammunition. The accused had been arrested with a revolver and six cartridges.